

Steelseries Ikari Optical Mouse and Steelseries 5L

Steal-series It's Not!

Steelseries, like Razer, are known as dedicated professional gaming hardware manufacturers. One of their latest contributions is the Ikari Optical Mouse and the 5L mousepad.

The mouse uses an optical sensor that has a resolution of 400 to 1600dpi. The mouse tracks well, and is a little better than the Logitech MX518. It has four huge feet that allow it to slide around easily on any surface.

The wide shape of the mouse suits those of you with larger hands, and you'll be able to rest your

entire palm on the mouse. The finish of the mouse is similar to the MX518—a glossy plastic centre and an anti-bacterial matte finish on either side. It's lighter than the MX518, but more reactive in-game.

Other than the 3 standard buttons, there is a button on top that switches the dpi. We did have some problems with the buttons—the left click kept getting stuck. The dpi toggles between two settings that need to be set using the drivers. There's not much of a choice though—400/800, 400/1600 and 800/1600 dpi are the only profiles you can choose from. Switching between DPIs takes a second or two, so it's not something you can do during a game.

We used the Steelseries 5L along with the Akari Optical and it performed very well. The surface is very smooth and it



works well with any mouse. The only issues with it are that it does get dirty pretty fast, and the edges around it are a little sharp. It's also a hard pad so it's not something you can roll up and carry with you. At Rs 2,849, only those who consider themselves professional gamers, or those with money to blow will buy it. For plain performance, we give it a

rating of 4/5.

The Steelseries Akari Optical is an expensive mouse as well—Rs 4,249. The tracking is excellent, but the benefits of using such a mouse might not justify the price you pay for it.

Specifications

Sensor resolution: 1600dpi, Polling rate: 1000Hz, 5 buttons, 2m braided cord

RATINGS

Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Build quality	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: SteelSeries ApS / Vstreet Netserve Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: +91-79-40020127
E-mail: sales@v-street.net
Web site: www.v-street.net
Price: Rs 4,249

Odyssey Internet Multimedia Keyboard-Mouse

Nothing Special

The Odyssey Internet Multimedia Keyboard Mouse is a wired optical mouse and a multimedia keyboard combo.

The keyboard has a standard layout, and the keys don't offer good feedback. It has multimedia keys to control your browser and other multimedia applications, though funnily, the volume controls are placed near the directional arrow keys. The keyboard comes with a detachable palm rest, but attaching the palm rest takes some doing, while removing it is just downright painful.

The mouse is a PS2 mouse, so tracking is nowhere as smooth as

high-end gaming mice, or even USB ones. The mouse is sturdy though, and has a glowing blue scroll wheel

that has a good feel, but not enough feedback when scrolling.

The shape of the mouse is actually pretty comfortable to use, and bumping the refresh rate to 200 cycles a second improves the performance a tad.

At Rs 400, this keyboard-mouse combo is dirt cheap.

Unfortunately, that's all it has going for it. Bottom line? An acceptable keyboard but a terrible mouse.

Contact: Compuage Infocom Ltd.
Phone: +91-9212100193
E-mail: info@compuageindia.com
Web site: www.compuageindia.com
Price: Rs 400



RATINGS

Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★